CHOOSE GREEN. CHOOSE THE FUTURE.

#GREEN NORGESGADE

2026

MMD26-IDEA CATALOGUE

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Esbjerg Municipality

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ANALYSIS AND RESEARCH

Norgesgade currently suffers from high asphalt runoff, causing basement flooding—a major pain point for residents like Erik. Research shows that a big percentage of stakeholders prioritize either economic security or social well-being. We bridge the gap between "green" goals and functional necessity.

Families like Morten and Nanna want a secure, lively "backyard" setting, while owners like Erik and Frederikke need concrete proof that green zones would reduce flood damage and boost property value. Our plan addresses the municipality's goal of a greener city center while satisfying the majority of the street's residents by combining high-capacity drainage with social touchpoints like the coffee hub and safe bike parking.

PERSONAS

The Economic Majority (3/6):

Erik, Frederikke, and Inge prioritize solutions that protect their investments. They require proof that the wildflower zones will prevent costly flood repairs and increase property value by the projected 12–15%.

The Social Majority (2/6):

Malene and Morten & Nanna seek community-driven spaces. Their primary needs are safety for children, biodiversity, and a vibrant streetscape that supports local business foot traffic.

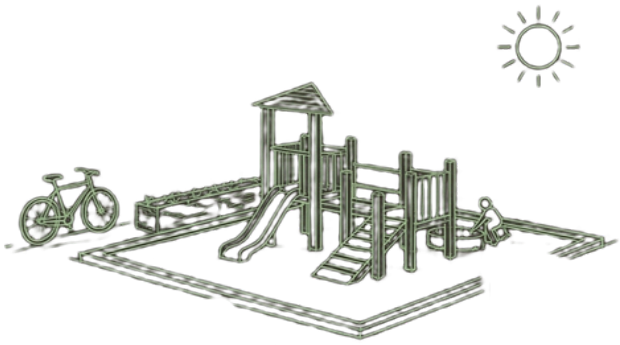
The Practical Skeptic (1/6):

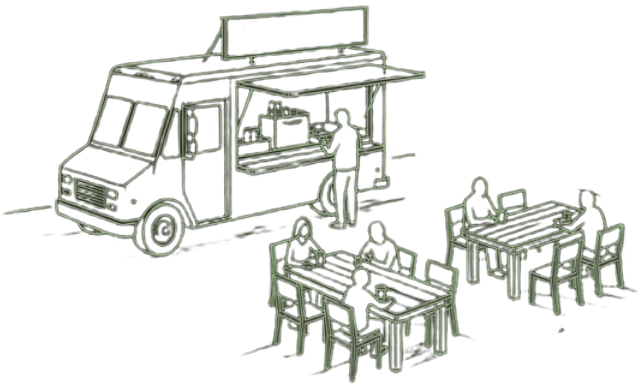
Tim values durability over trends. To satisfy his "C-profile," we utilize native planting and iron-ivy fencing that requires minimal maintenance and mimics traditional, proven urban design.

IDEA 1: THE SOCIAL HUB

The centerpiece of our urban intervention is the complete conversion of the underutilized, high-runoff asphalt basketball court into a multifunctional "Social-Green Hub". This area, currently a "grey" transit zone, is reimagined as a destination that fosters community interaction while serving critical environmental functions.

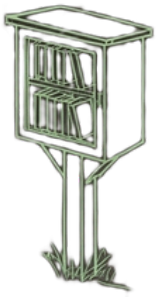
Sustainable Playground: A sensory play area constructed entirely from recycled larch wood and natural materials. This feature specifically appeals to Frederikke's "Recycling is gold" mindset and Malene's focus on future generations.

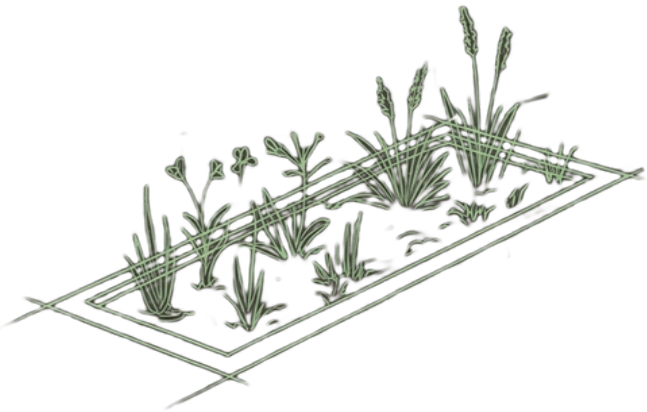




Cafe Truck: A designated zone for a mobile coffee stand designed to stimulate the local economy. By creating a reason for residents to "stay" rather than just "pass through," we increase the potential foot traffic for surrounding businesses like Malene's health food store and Frederikke's dental clinic.

The Community Book Cabinet: An upcycled "take-one-leave-one" library station. This low-cost, high-impact touchpoint encourages social cohesion and supports Frederikke's preference for frugal, community-oriented solutions.





Wildflower Integration: The perimeter of the hub is lined with native wildflower patches that serve as a natural transition between the social space and the street. These patches are integrated into the "Sponge Effect" irrigation system to manage rainwater locally.

IDEA 2: GREEN MOBILITY

To truly modernize Norgesgade, we must address the "missing links" in its current infrastructure. Our site analysis revealed that the existing car parking lot is a high-runoff "grey zone" that contributes to local flooding and heat. By integrating Green Mobility with Vertical Nature, we transform this functional necessity into a high-performing urban ecosystem.

Integrated Parking Transformation: We are redesigning the car parking lot to include permeable grass-paving and extra deciduous trees. This reduces the "Urban Heat Island" effect and allows rainwater to soak into the ground rather than flooding the street. This cooling of the microclimate is a key "Smart City" metric that appeals to Inge's interest in future-proofed environments.

The Iron & Ivy Buffer: Surrounding the parking lot, we are installing durable iron fencing pre-grown with climbing ivy. This feature is a "triple-threat" solution:

1. Aesthetics: It hides the "metal forest" of cars with a classic look that appeals to Tim.
2. Health: Ivy acts as a natural bio-filter, trapping fine dust and CO2 from car exhausts.
3. Acoustics: The dense foliage serves as a noise buffer for Frederikke's clinic patients.

High-Capacity Bike Parking: Adjacent to the car stalls, we are installing modern, secure racks for standard and cargo bikes. This addresses the current deficiency in the area, supporting Morten & Nanna's lifestyle and encouraging Malene's customers to choose carbon-neutral transport.

This isn't just about adding racks; it's about behavioral design. By upgrading the parking lot with "green screens" and trees, we make the entire street more desirable. This holistic approach proves to Inge and Frederikke that we are thinking about Norgesgade as a long-term, functional asset that increases the value of the entire neighborhood.

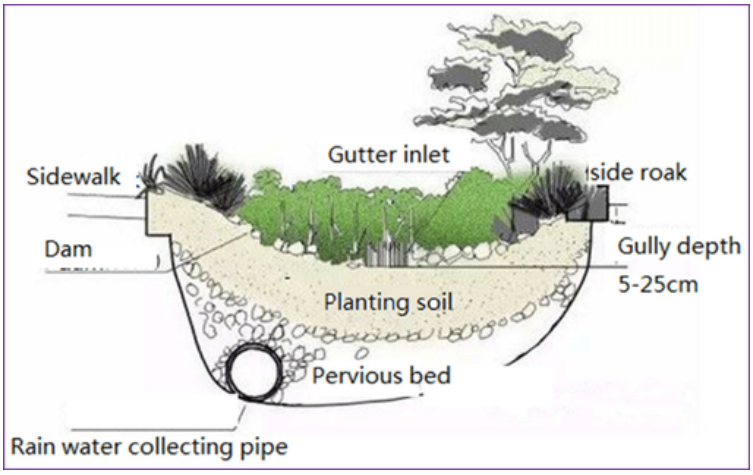
IDEA 3: THE URBAN SPONGE

The technical foundation of Norgesgade is a high-capacity rainwater management system designed to turn an environmental threat into a resource. By replacing the current "sealed" asphalt surfaces with a sophisticated Local Rainwater Action (LAR) system, we move from a reactive flooding model to a proactive, nature-based drainage solution.

The System: Infiltration & Accumulation

The proposed design utilizes the transformed zones as a network of Rain Gardens. These are engineered "sink" zones designed to manage water through two distinct stages:

- Stage 1: Surface Infiltration: The top layer consists of bio-retention soil and deep-rooted native wildflowers. These plants create natural vertical channels in the earth, allowing water to bypass the surface quickly rather than pooling.
- Stage 2: The Accumulation Area: Below the surface lies a hidden accumulation reservoir (a gravel-filled basin or "faskine"). During a cloudburst, this area acts as a temporary underground buffer. It stores excess water that the soil cannot immediately process, holding it securely until it can naturally soak into the deeper ground layers.



Picture provided from: https://www.researchgate.net/figure/Conceptual-picture-of-sponge-city_fig2_327751708

The Data: Preventing the Cloudburst Crisis

To satisfy the need for practical, proven solutions, the proposal is backed by hydrological principles:

- 90% Runoff Reduction: By replacing non-permeable surfaces with these "sponge" zones, immediate surface runoff is reduced by up to 90%.
- Relieving the Infrastructure: The underground accumulation area "buys time" for the city's main sewer system. By capturing thousands of liters on-site and releasing them slowly, the system prevents the hydraulic pressure that typically causes backflow and basement flooding.

This engineering approach proves that "green" infrastructure is not fragile. By combining nature's ancient filtration methods with a high-capacity accumulation reservoir, we provide a durable, low-maintenance foundation that protects the physical and financial health of the neighborhood.

SoMe CAMPAIGN

To align with our project's core values, the #GreenNorgesgade campaign utilizes a Sustainable Dark aesthetic. By choosing high-contrast, low-brightness imagery, we purposefully reduce energy consumption on OLED mobile devices (UI/UX sustainability) while creating an intimate, premium atmosphere that distinguishes our project from standard municipal communications.

The Campaign Trilogy: A Strategic Rollout

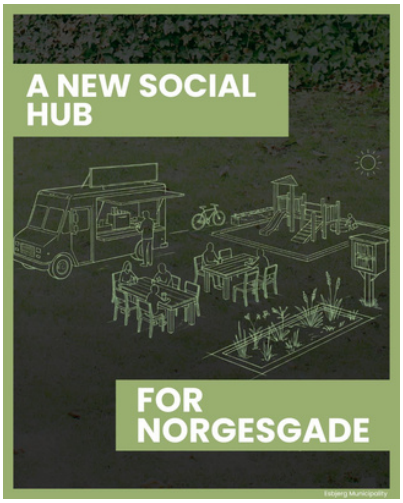
We have developed three distinct visual pillars to move our six stakeholder personas from skepticism to community action:

Post 1: The Emotional Hook | "Choose Future Generations"

-Visual Strategy: Uses child-like, hand-drawn overlays on a "grey" urban background.

-Target Persona: Morten & Nanna (The Families).

-Goal: To shift the conversation from "construction noise" to "legacy." It frames the green transition as a gift for the children of Norgesgade.

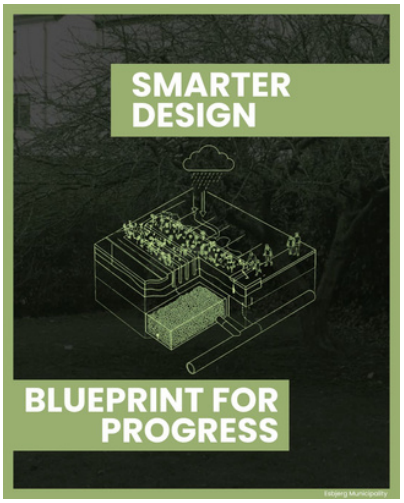


Post 2: The Behavioral Shift | "A New Social Hub"

-Visual Strategy: An architectural "sketch-overlay" visualizing the lifestyle change (Coffee truck, playground, social interaction).

-Target Persona: Malene (The Local Business Owner).

-Goal: To prove economic and social viability. It shows Malene exactly how the "Hub" will bring foot traffic back to her health store.



Post 3: The Technical Proof | "Smarter Design"

-Visual Strategy: A high-fidelity technical blueprint showing the "Sponge Effect" LAR system.

-Target Persona: Inge (The Tech-Investor) & Erik (The Skeptic).

-Goal: To provide technical reassurance. This post proves that "green" is not fragile—it is a high-performance engineering solution that protects property values and prevents flooding.

SoMe CAMPAIGN

Video

The #GreenNorgesgade 2026 video serves as a cinematic call to action that effectively bridges the gap between Esbjerg Municipality's vision and the functional needs of its residents. By utilizing a "Sustainable Dark" aesthetic, the production purposefully reduces energy consumption on mobile devices while creating a premium, intimate atmosphere that distinguishes the campaign from standard municipal communications. The narrative moves from a "grey" black-and-white reality of high-runoff asphalt to a vibrant, colorized vision of community life, validating the desires of stakeholders like Morten, Nanna, and Malene for a secure and lively "backyard" setting. At 31 seconds long, the film perfectly satisfies the technical requirements for the Week 1 Awareness phase of the SoMe calendar, framing the transition as a vital legacy for future generations.

Choice of Media & 4-Week Calendar

The #GreenNorgesgade 2026 social media campaign is structured around a four-week strategic rollout designed to guide stakeholders through a complete conversion funnel. Starting in Week 1, the Awareness phase utilizes a cinematic video on Facebook and Instagram to highlight the current "grey" reality and establish a baseline for the green transition. This is followed in Week 2 by the Education phase across LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram, featuring Post 3 ("Smarter Design") to provide technical and data-driven proof of the project's feasibility to skeptical homeowners and tech investors. During Week 3, the Desire phase shifts focus to Post 2 ("A New Social Hub") on Facebook and Instagram, visualizing the behavioral benefits and vibrant lifestyle changes intended for local business owners and residents. The campaign culminates in Week 4 with the Action phase, where Post 1 ("Choose Future Generations") serves as an emotional call to community action, framing the green choice as a lasting legacy for the neighborhood.

Week	**Phase**	Platform	Content
Week 1	Awareness	Facebook/Instagram	Video
Week 2	Education	LinkedIn/FB/Insta	Post 3
Week 3	Desire	Facebook/Instagram	Post 2
Week 4	Action	Facebook/Instagram	Post 1

BUDGET

By prioritizing upcycled materials and donated greenery, the adjusted financial outlook for Norgesgade is as follows:

Category	High-Tech/New Cost	Upcycled/Nature-Led Cost
LAR System	3.2M DKK+ per ha	~1.8M – 2.4M DKK per ha
Social Hub	450,000 DKK	~85,000 – 150,000 DKK
Green Mobility	120,000 DKK	~60,000 – 90,000 DKK

Item	Unit	Estimated Cost (New)	Upcycled/Donated Potential
Native Wildflower Seeds	per 100 m2	400 – 800 DKK	0 DKK (Community seed-swap or harvested from local parks)
Deciduous Saplings	per tree	1,500 – 4,500 DKK	500 – 1,000 DKK (Sourcing younger "whips" or local nursery donations)
Climbing Ivy	per linear meter	200 – 500 DKK	0 DKK (Propagated from existing local cuttings)

To optimize this budget, the project heavily emphasizes the upcycling of local materials: the community book cabinet and sensory planters will be crafted from salvaged wood and industrial off-cuts, while the "Iron & Ivy" buffer can utilize reclaimed metal fencing. Furthermore, by choosing to adaptively reuse the existing basketball court rather than opting for a full demolition, we project a 12% to 15% saving in initial construction costs. This "frugal" engineering approach satisfies the needs of Tim, who values durability over trends, and Frederikke, who believes "recycling is gold". It proves to the Esbjerg Municipality that the project is not just a "green" goal, but a concrete, financially responsible asset that protects the financial health of the neighborhood.

The total projected investment for the #GreenNorgesgade 2026 transformation—including the nature-based Urban Sponge (LAR) system, upcycled Social Hub, and Green Mobility infrastructure—is estimated between **1,960,000 DKK and 2,775,000 DKK.**

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